

3.1 The Beginning of Time...

Consoles started to make their appearance during the early '70s, with the Magnavox Odyssey 100 credited as the very first game console ever. Back then it was very easy to identify game console apart by its looks. They were big and extremely bulky compared to today's consoles.



Pong being played on a home console

Moreover, they worked with cartridges rather than the now-customary CD or DVD. Nevertheless, some aspects have remained unchanged over the years, however: till date, consoles need to be connected to a TV for viewing (unless it is a handheld, like the Sony PSP). Furthermore they still come with their own, unique controllers. But this isn't true all the time—today it's possible to plug in keyboards via USB.

The history of consoles begins with the 1972 Magnavox Odyssey. It is credited as being the very first gaming console, and therefore with establishing the video games industry. Legend has it that Ralph Baer, the person credited with having invented the very first video game, created a video game console prototype in 1967, called the Brown Box. This system, which later became the standard template for all consoles, was presented to the RCA (Radio Corporation of America), who were unimpressed. It did however catch the eye of one of the RCA employees involved in the negotiation process, who then left the company for Magnavox. Magnavox then acquired the rights for Baer's technology, and, like they say, the rest is history.